

# USMAN IBRAHIM

Cybersecurity Student | SOC Analyst | Application Security

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student specializing in application security, SOC operations, and Digital Forensics and Incident Response (DFIR). Hands-on experience hardening a production POS platform against SQL injection, XSS, privilege escalation, and session hijacking through layered RBAC, Row Level Security, and strict input validation. SOC background triaging 30+ daily alerts in Splunk and Wazuh and correlating events against MITRE ATT&CK TTPs. National-level CTF challenge author with expertise in memory and network forensics, and business development experience supporting enterprise AI proposals. Seeking a SOC Analyst, AppSec, or Defensive Security Internship.

## CORE COMPETENCIES

Application Security | SOC Operations | Incident Response | MITRE ATT&CK | IOC Analysis | Threat Hunting | Access Control (RBAC) | Database Security (RLS) | Input Validation | Session Security | Digital Forensics | Vulnerability Assessment

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Application Security:** RBAC, Row Level Security (RLS), Input Validation (Zod), SQLi/XSS Prevention, JWT Session Hardening, CSP/HSTS/Security Headers, Rate Limiting

**Security Operations:** SOC Operations, Alert Triage, Incident Response, DFIR, Threat Hunting, IOC Analysis

**SIEM and Forensics Tools:** Splunk, Wazuh, Elastic Stack (ELK), Wireshark, Volatility 3, Autopsy, Belkasoft

**Network Security:** TCP/IP, OSPF, EIGRP, RIPv2, NAT, Extended ACLs, Cisco Packet Tracer

**Frameworks and Standards:** MITRE ATT&CK, ISO/IEC 27001, NIST Cybersecurity Framework

## EXPERIENCE

### Security Research Intern

*NetraLink Solutions | July 2026 - August 2026*

- Owned Analytics, Audit, and Reporting for DeWall, a self-hosted DNS Firewall platform (Go microservices, PostgreSQL, ClickHouse, React/TypeScript), combining security research with hands-on testing and development.
- Conducted comprehensive security and functional testing on the analytics pipeline, finding and fixing production-blocking issues including silent data loss in event handling and a hidden mock-data flag that was masking a real CORS misconfiguration.
- Identified and flagged an authentication gap in the API gateway allowing header-based user impersonation.
- Produced technical documentation including API documentation and internal security testing reports.

### SOC Analyst Intern

*Tech Hierarchy | March 2026*

- Triaged 30+ daily security alerts in Wazuh and Splunk, correlating IOCs against MITRE ATT&CK TTPs to classify indicators of compromise and escalate confirmed incidents per established SOC runbooks.

### Challenge Author - NASCON 2026 Forensics Arena & RDX National CTF

*FAST NUCES Islamabad | June 2025 - August 2026*

- Authored a hard-category memory forensics challenge (MITRE T1003.001) requiring Volatility 3 analysis, and 6 additional challenges for RDX National CTF (100+ participants combined).

### Business Development Intern

*Intellemia | May 2026 - Present*

- Manage the full B2B sales cycle for enterprise AI solutions (RAG, LLM, Voice AI, computer vision) at an AI consultancy, from client research to technical proposal writing and system architecture diagram design.
- Manage the company's Upwork profile, which holds Top Rated Plus status with 100% Job Success.

## EDUCATION

### Bachelor of Science in Cyber Security

*FAST National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences, Islamabad | August 2024 - June 2028*

- Relevant Coursework: Software Engineering, Cybersecurity-I, Computer Networks

**Cyber Space Legion | University Cybersecurity Society**

- Head of Finance (2025 - Present): led finance team for flagship events, managed sponsor relations and budgeting.

## CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Defensive Security Analyst (CDSA) | Hack The Box (In Progress)
- Security Operations Center (SOC) | Cisco

- Network Security | Cisco
- ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Information Security Associate | SkillFront
- Computer Networks and Network Security | IBM

## PROJECTS

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### **PIMS - POS Inventory Management System** | *Next.js, Supabase (PostgreSQL), TypeScript, Vercel* | July 2025

- Engineered a granular RBAC system enforced across three layers (client UI, edge middleware, server APIs) to prevent horizontal and vertical privilege escalation.
- Implemented PostgreSQL Row Level Security policies for strict tenant data isolation and restricted the admin service key to prevent unauthorized database-wide mutations.
- Eliminated SQL injection and XSS vectors through type-safe Zod schema validation and parameterized queries, and built a global error-sanitization pipeline to prevent schema and stack-trace leakage.
- Hardened sessions with strictly configured JWTs and enforced CSP, HSTS, and X-Frame-Options headers; protected automated cron jobs against DoS and SSRF with cryptographic header validation.

### **NextGen Residency - Smart Housing Society Platform** | *MongoDB, Express.js, React 18, Node.js* | Jan 2026 - May 2026

- Hardened backend API with Helmet.js security headers, CSRF protection, and NoSQL injection prevention; integrated TOTP-based two-factor authentication and JWT with refresh tokens across a triple-portal RBAC architecture.

### **Cybersecurity Portfolio** | *React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS* | 2025

- Hardened the platform with strict HTTP security headers (CSP, HSTS, X-Frame-Options) and CORS scoped tightly to the production domain.
- Engineered a serverless backend API with server-side input validation and custom IP-based rate limiting to mitigate spam and automated abuse.

### **Enterprise Multi-Area Network Architecture** | *Cisco Packet Tracer, OSPF, EIGRP, RIPv2* | 2026

- Engineered a multi-area network topology across 19 routers and 11 switches with mutual route redistribution, Static NAT, and Extended ACLs for host and subnet-level security policies.

## ACHIEVEMENTS AND COMPETITIONS

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- 3rd Place, SudoFuzzers CTF (top 6% of 50+ teams) and 7th Place, CyberFest 2025 (top 7% of 100+ teams), including individual recognition as Star of CyberFest '25.